CitizenOne

CitizenOne is a secure, modular e-services platform that streamlines online service delivery for governments while ensuring privacy, trust, and compliance. With a single, secure login, it simplifies access to services. Built on open standards like OAuth/OIDC and SAML, its scalable architecture supports diverse users and services. Trusted for its ready-to-deploy solutions, CitizenOne enhances security and reduces cyber risks.

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Measuring E-Governance

The E-Government Development Index (EGDI), established in 2001, is a composite index used by the United Nations to measure the progress and readiness of e-government development across its 193 member states. It assesses how governments leverage information and communication technology (ICT) to deliver public services efficiently and effectively. The EGDI is published biennially in the UN's E-Government Survey.

EGDI Ranking

	Canada	Denmark	Estonia	Singapore
2024	47th	1st	2nd	3rd
2022	32nd	1st	8th	12th
⋮				
2003	6th	4th	16th	12th

At this time, C1 is used by Canadian municipalities and provincial gov. Throughout the years, Canada has seen a huge decline in the EDGI ranks.

Our Team

MB
General Manager

NB
Software Architect

BL
UX Design Lead

Marisa
Senior UX Designer

XW
UX Designer

AP
Full Stack Developer

ML
Front-End Developer

JH
Front-End Developer

AA
Front-End Developer

FL
DevOps Specialist

Problems & Opportunities

E-Services In Canada

Digital credentials are part of C1 but I didn't work on this.

In our user testing, few users reported experience with digital credentials but were familiar with the concept.

- Only 23% of federal government services are fully available online.
- The Auditor General reported that federal government departments manage up to 90 separate sign-in systems independently.
- Leading EGDI countries offer a single access point to government services through digital credentials.
- 90% of Canadians support digital credentials.
- Countries that successfully implement digital credentials could see GDP growth of 3% to 13% by 2030.
  - Trusted digital credentials could add a minimum 1% to Canada's GDP, equating to CAD $15 billion.

Project Overview

Project Timeline: Late 2022 – Ongoing

Objective: Completing version 3 redesign of the platform. Reasons for starting over:

- Version 2 uses an uncommon code language.
- V2 has a confusing UI and out of date IA.
- Overall it would've taken a lot of work to undo V2 as it stood.

I joined the C1 team in March 2023 and later spent five months on a client's website redesign. During my time on C1, I completed V3 designs for 23 features before transitioning to another product's redesign in 2024. This deck focuses on the redesign of the flow for eService Creation in the C1 platform – though the process was consistent across all 23.

Feature Info

Creating a Service is a key flow in the CitizenOne platform. To do this, Admins need to set up the following:

- a government organization
- the offered services + actions
- requirements to use the service
- Info about use of user details

Example for Context

Organization: Ministry of Transport

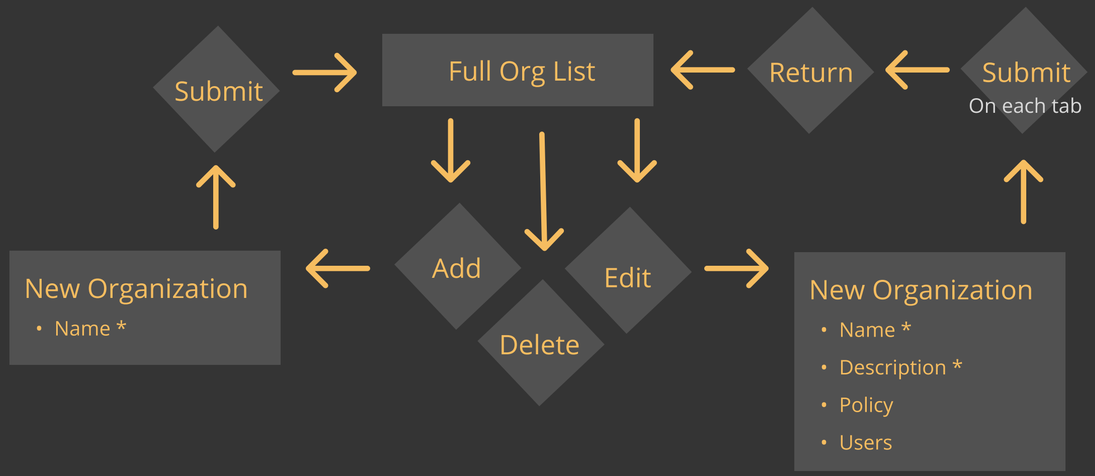
Service (Card): Driver’s Licenses, Motorcycle Licenses

Actions: Apply for Learner’s Permit, Renew License, Change Address

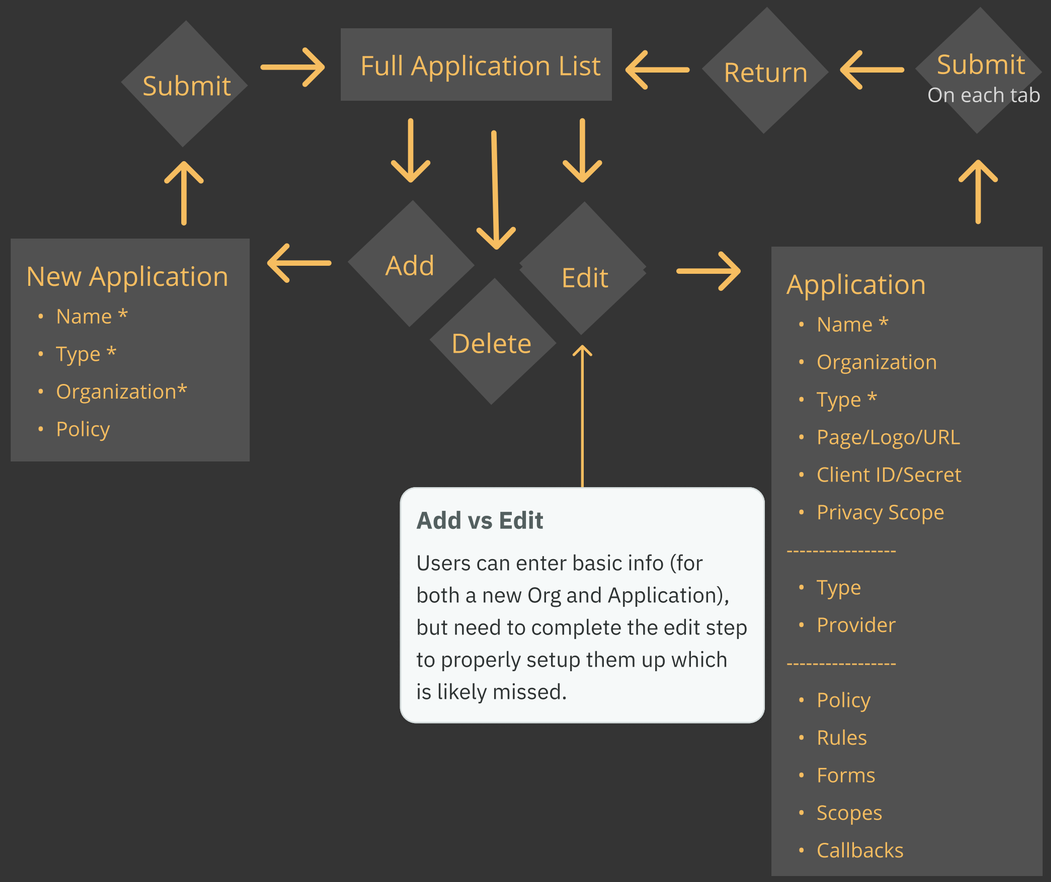
Ver 2 Flow

Step 1 Setup or Manage an Organization

It isn't clear in the UI that these are connected and that is a multi-step process. Users could try to complete this step 2 first and lose their work if they have no Orgs ready.



Step 2 Setup or Manage an Application (Service)



Design Process Note

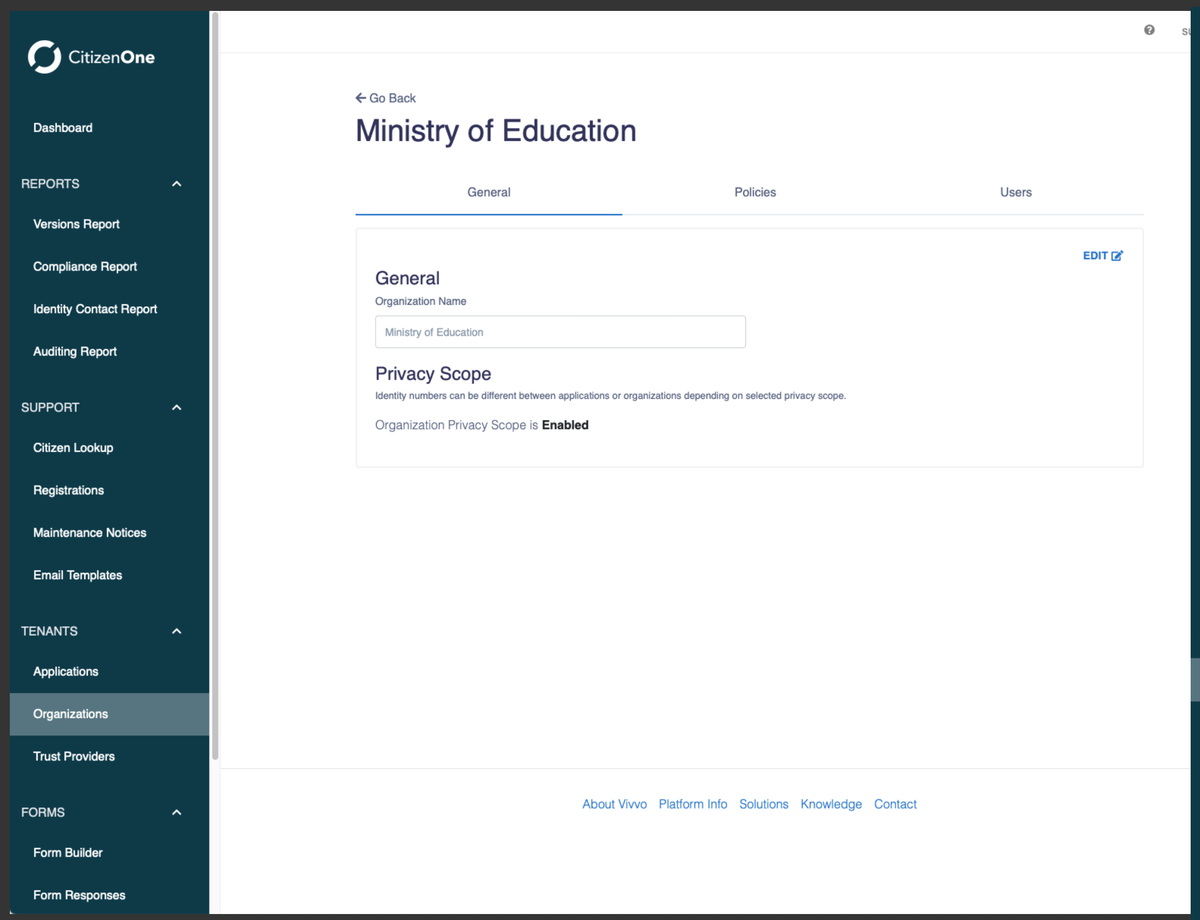
The Lead Designer did not want me to review the current platform due to fear of basis and confusion about the features that would be redundant in V3. She felt that V2 was really really bad and that it was best to work from scratch. So I was blind to how V2 functioned for the whole of the redesign.

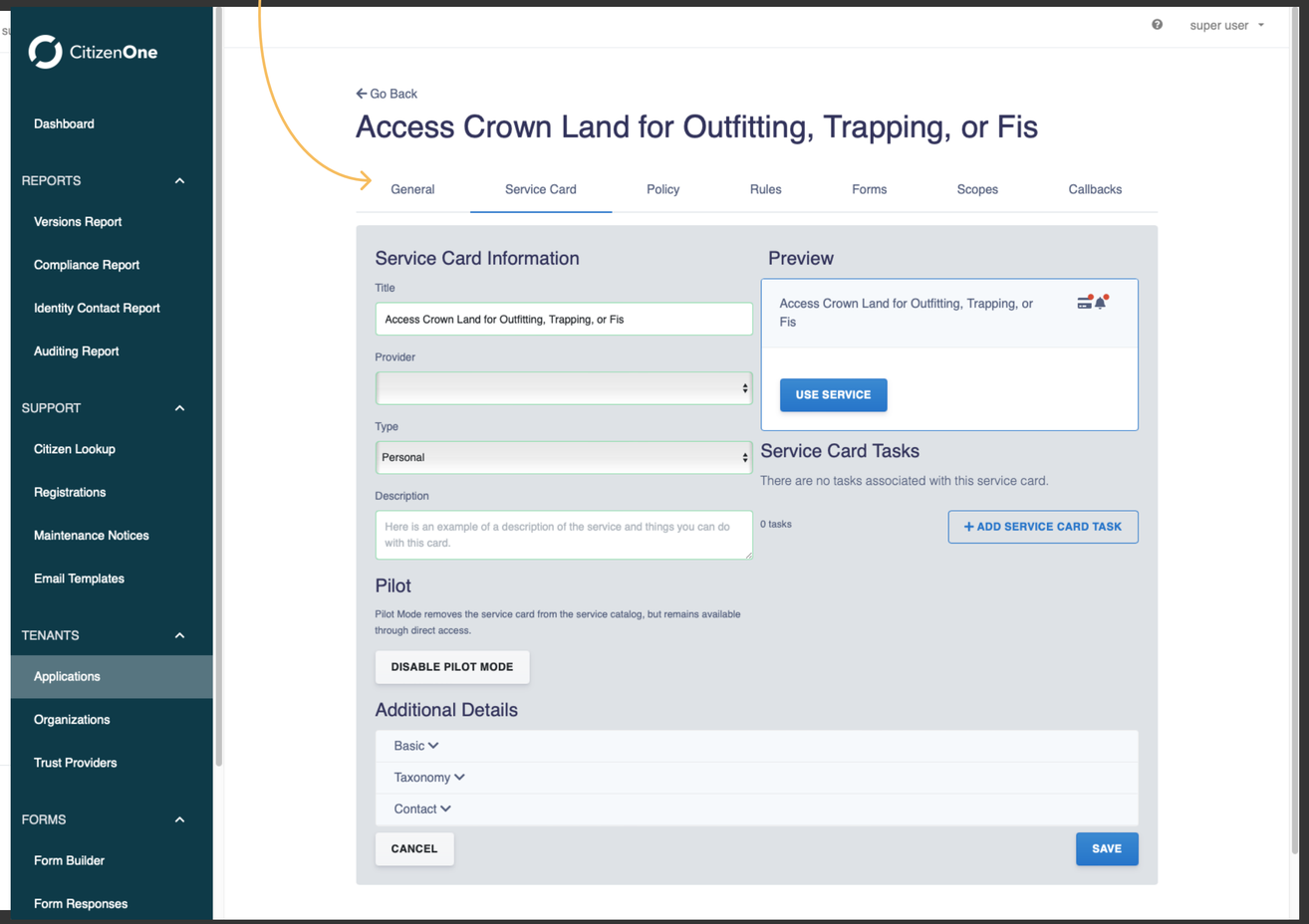
Add vs Edit

Users can enter basic info (for both a new Org and Application), but need to complete the edit step to properly setup them up which is likely missed.

Overview

Connecting to the Org happens under this tab via dropdown selection.





Organization Overview (V2)

This interface never mentions an Orgs connection to the applications.

Application Overview (V2)

Applications in V3 is made redundant while some names are changed for better comprehension.

Key Problems

- Navigation doesn’t clearly show the relationships in the platform.
  - Related content lives separately.
- The UI hides a lot of content in the navs.
  - Users need to scroll in the main nav.
  - Page nav uses an accordion. Doesn’t work well for keyboard only navigation.
- Nomenclature is confusing.
- To speed up setup, users are only provided half of the steps need but they likely fail setup because of this and rely on C1 support team.
- Some setups are too bloated can be simplified

Note: I would’ve love to have completed interviews with users to learn about their processes, issues they have, and used terms before starting the redesign. The team seemed to rely on internal SMEs and experiences from V2. The latter of which I lacked – but this seemed to be preferred by the Design Lead.

How might we...

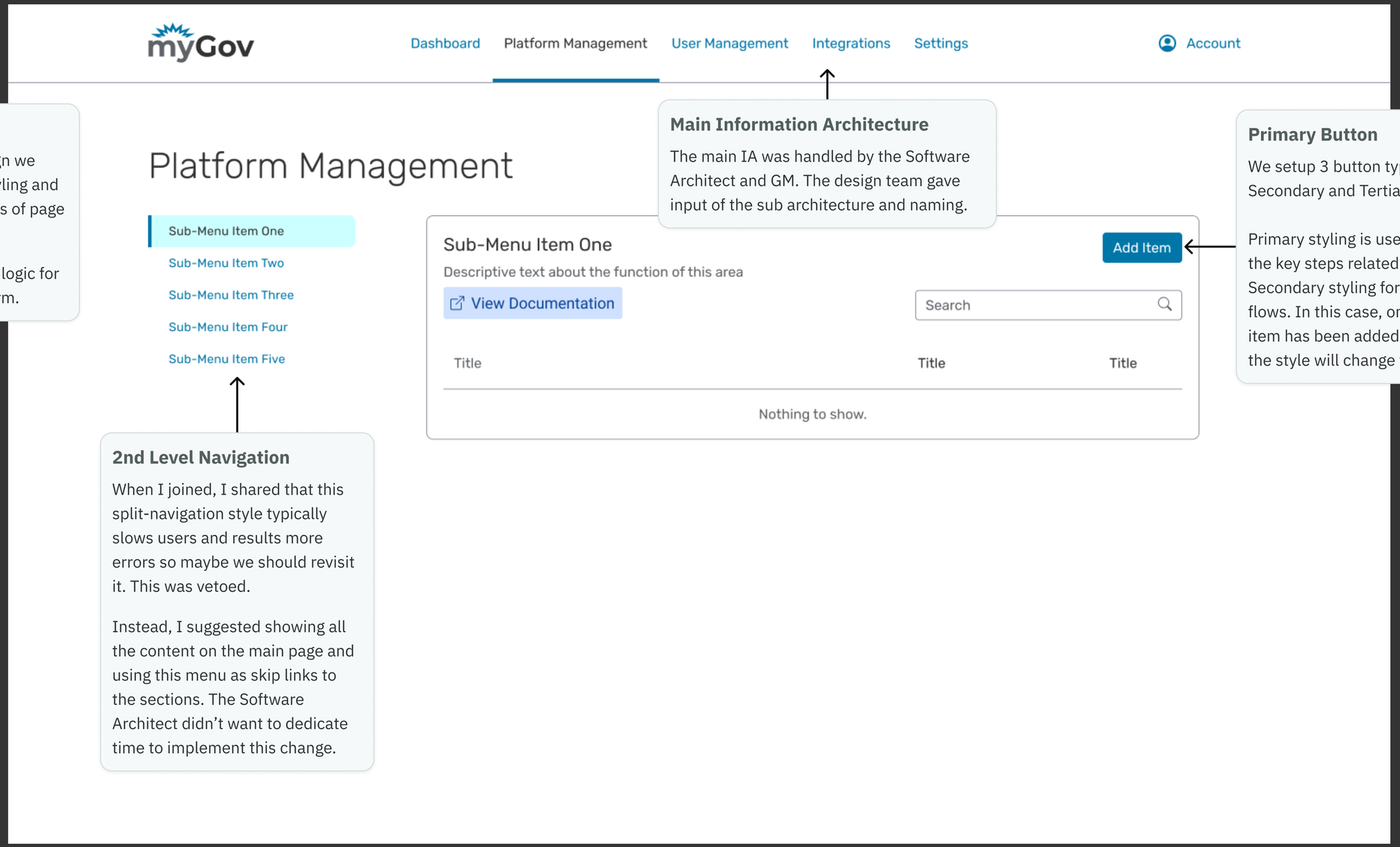
Improve the Information Architecture of the product to ensure users can easily navigate and find what they need?

Streamline the setup to reduce complexity and eliminate fragmentation in the product experience?

Ensure the design is both flexible and scalable for different needs?

Product & Design Decisions

Design



Design System Base

At the start of the redesign we came up with the new styling and visual patterns for 3 levels of page hierarchy.

I also handled the colour logic for white-labeling the platform.

Main Information Architecture

The main IA was handled by the Software Architect and GM. The design team gave input of the sub architecture and naming.

Primary Button

We setup 3 button types (Primary, Secondary and Tertiary).

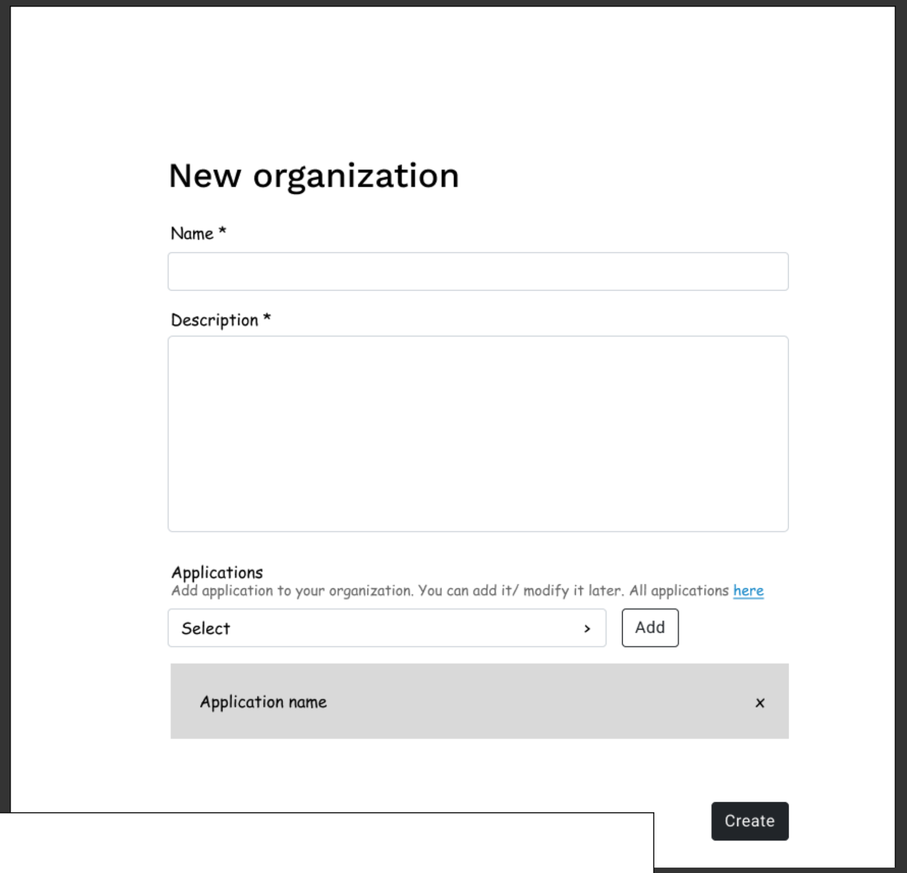
Primary styling is used to highlight the key steps related to the flow. Secondary styling for optional flows. In this case, once the first item has been added to the list, the style will change to secondary.

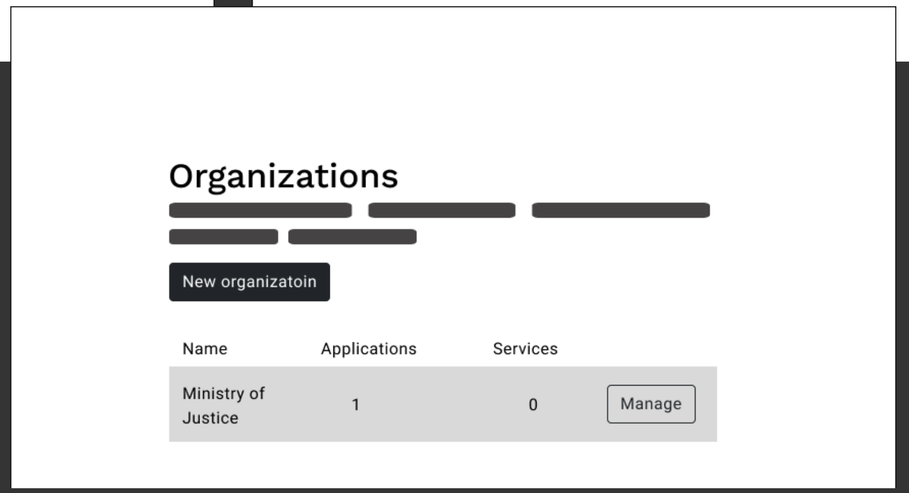
2nd Level Navigation

When I joined, I shared that this split-navigation style typically slows users and results more errors so maybe we should revisit it. This was vetoed.

Instead, I suggested showing all the content on the main page and using this menu as skip links to the sections. The Software Architect didn't want to dedicate time to implement this change.

Design

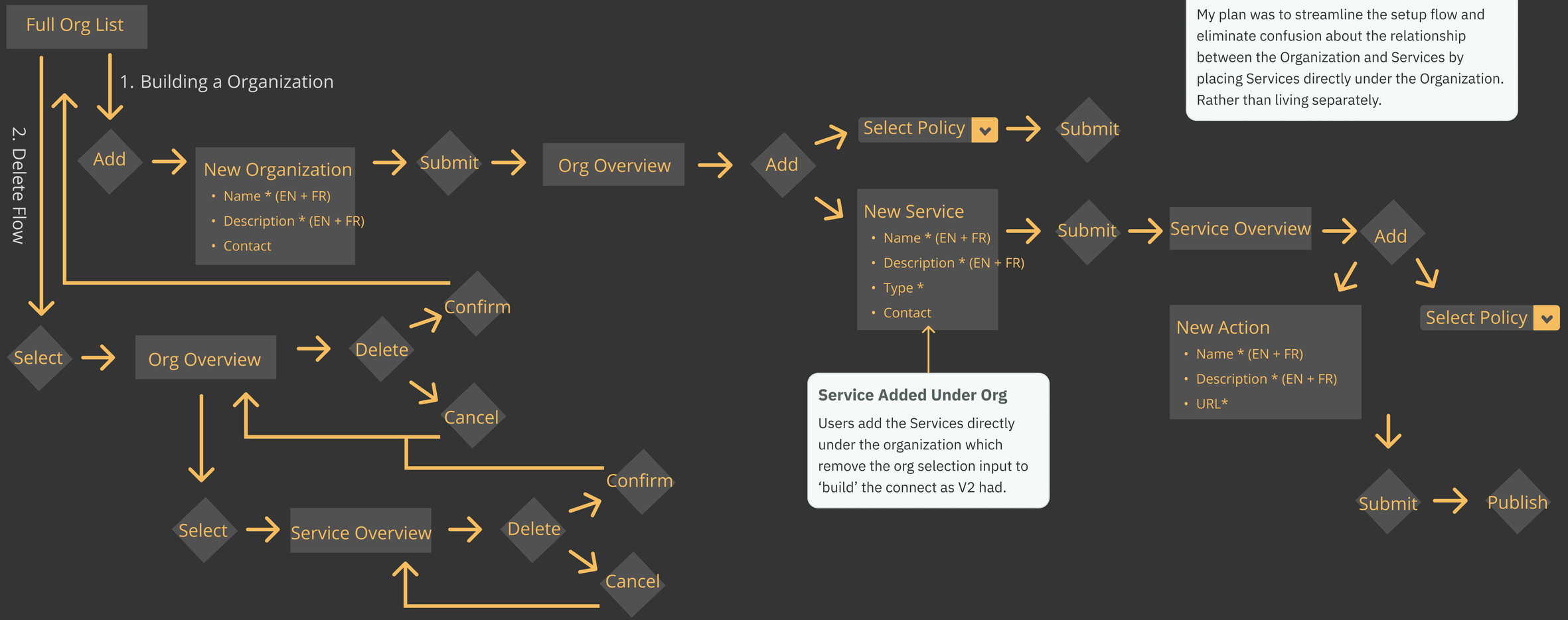




Wireframes

These were some wireframes that the Design Lead had worked on. I struggled to follow along with them and they seem to largely replicate aspects of V2. I decided to start by re-envisioning the flow of the feature.

Revised Ver 3 Flow



IA Change

My plan was to streamline the setup flow and eliminate confusion about the relationship between the Organization and Services by placing Services directly under the Organization. Rather than living separately.

Service Added Under Org

Users add the Services directly under the organization which remove the org selection input to ‘build’ the connect as V2 had.

Scope

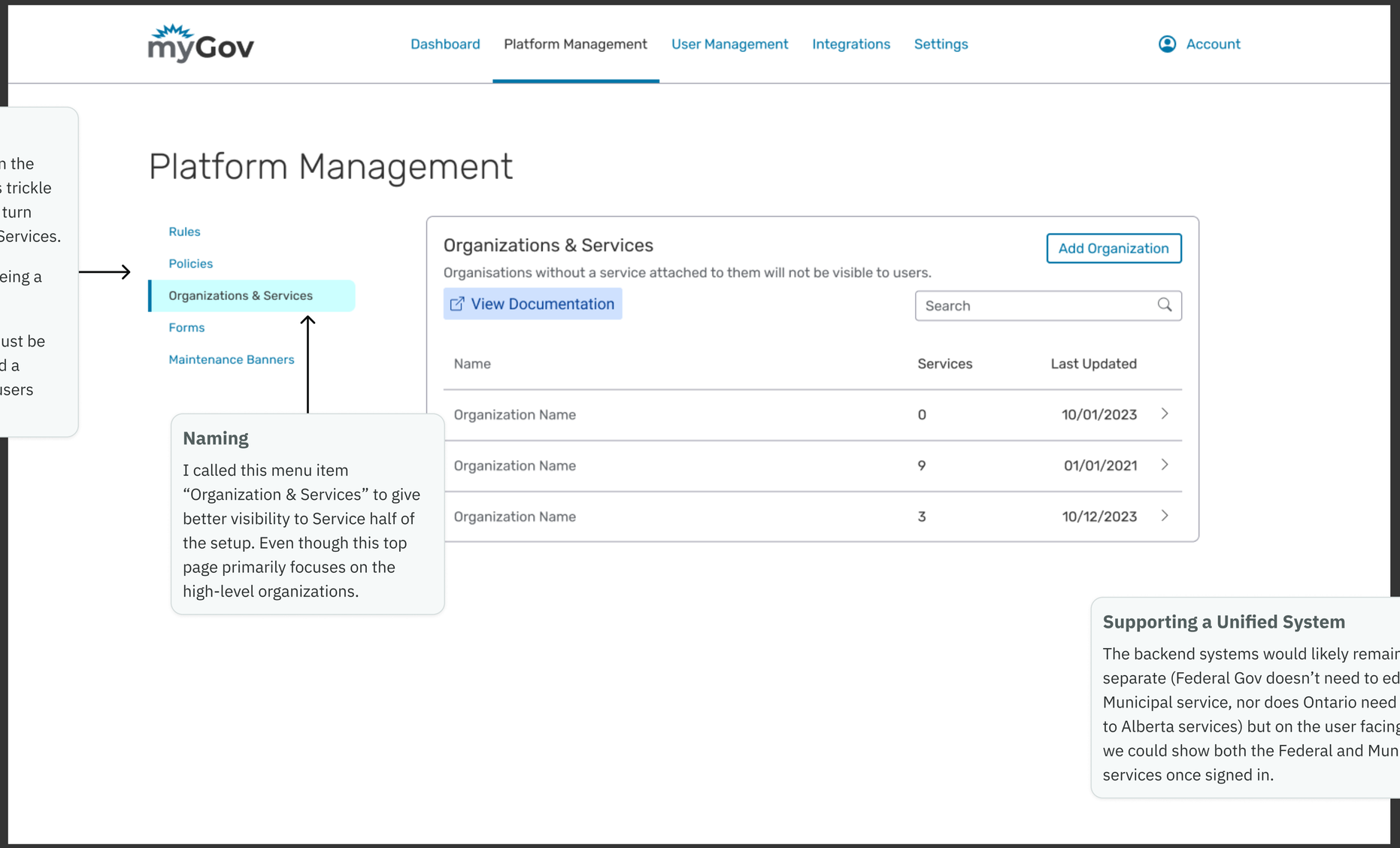
- Organization Overview Pages
- Setup of a Service (EN + FR)
- Setup for Actions (EN + FR)
- Selection + Removal of a Policy
- Visual Presentation of Policies
- Deleting Organization, Services, Actions
- Draft/Published States for Services

Not in Scope

- Setup for a Organization *
- Setup of Policies + Rules *
- Versioning for Services

* Due to the relationship of all these functions, it would have been my preference to tackle them all at the same time to ensure cohesion, but I was asked to focus on the Service part only.

Design



Side Menu Order

This is organized based on the flow of information: Rules trickle down to policies which in turn affect Organizations and Services.

Rules: Being over 18 or being a citizen etc.

Policies: The rules that must be met to use the service and a statement of intent with users info.

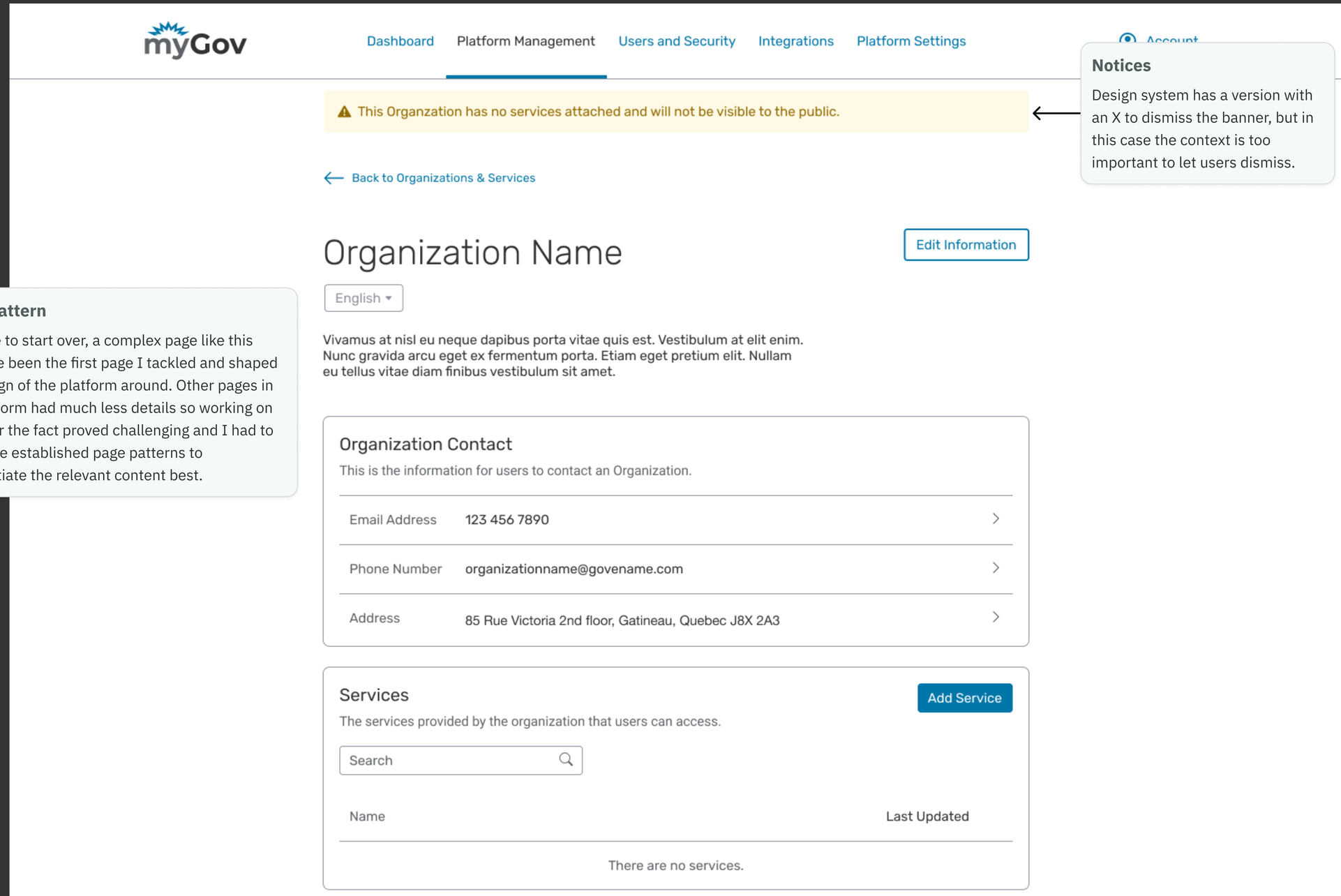
Naming

I called this menu item “Organization & Services” to give better visibility to Service half of the setup. Even though this top page primarily focuses on the high-level organizations.

Supporting a Unified System

The backend systems would likely remain separate (Federal Gov doesn’t need to edit Municipal service, nor does Ontario need access to Alberta services) but on the user facing side we could show both the Federal and Municipal services once signed in.

Desig
n



Page Pattern

If I were to start over, a complex page like this would've been the first page I tackled and shaped the design of the platform around. Other pages in the platform had much less details so working on this after the fact proved challenging and I had to break the established page patterns to differentiate the relevant content best.

Notices

Design system has a version with an X to dismiss the banner, but in this case the context is too important to let users dismiss.

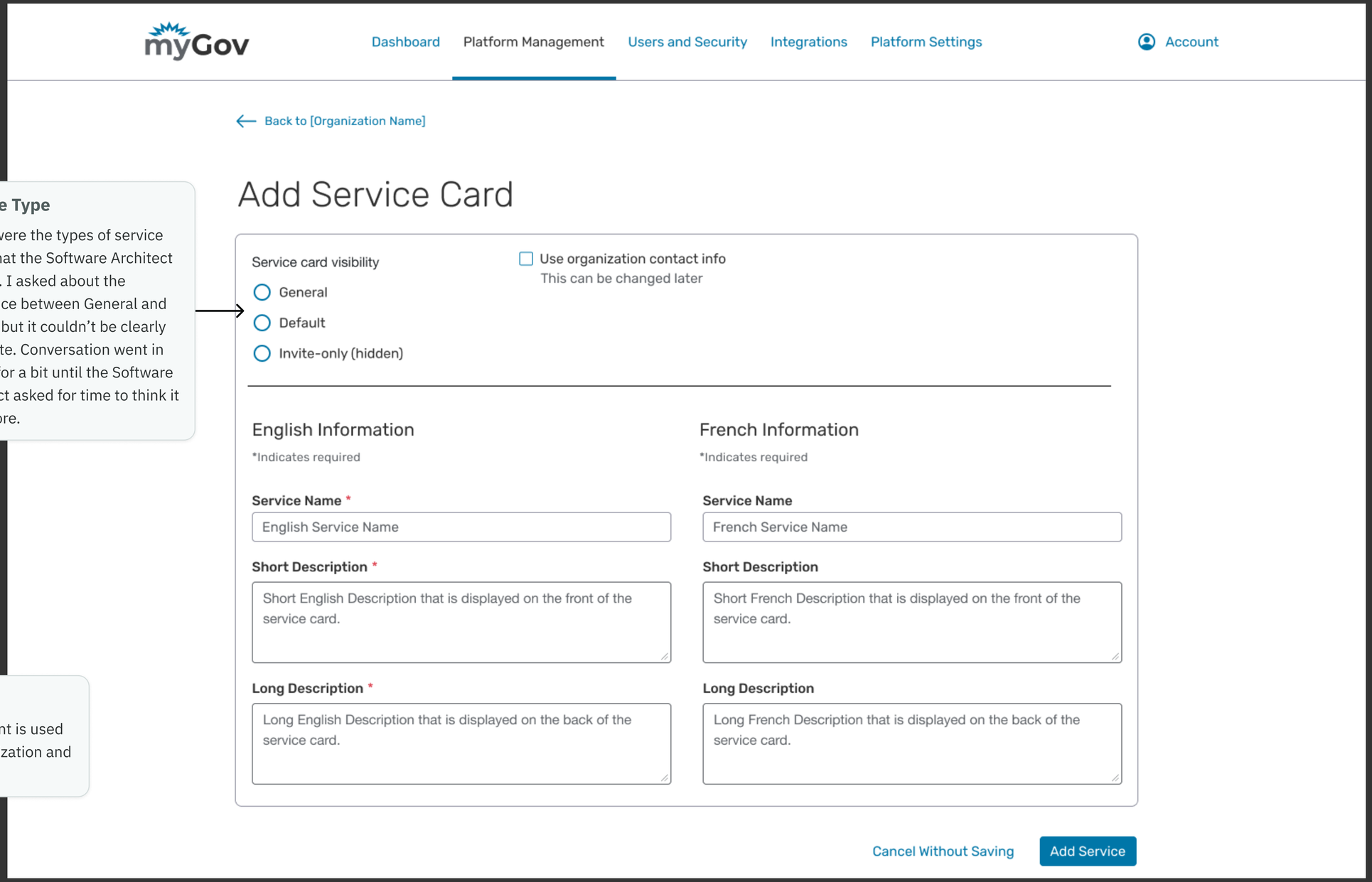
Scroll

Service Type

These were the types of service cards that the Software Architect wanted. I asked about the difference between General and Default but it couldn't be clearly articulate. Conversation went in circles for a bit until the Software Architect asked for time to think it over more.

Level 3 Page

Similar page and content is used for adding a new organization and actions as seen here.



myGov

Dashboard | Platform Management | User Management | Integrations | Settings | Account

← Back to [Organization Name]

Service Name V0.1

Edit Information

English Draft Default

Created: 2019-02-11

Vivamus at nisl eu neque dapibus porta vitae quis est. Vestibulum at elit enim. Nunc gravida arcu eget ex fermentum porta. Etiam eget pretium elit. Nullam eu tellus vitae diam finibus vestibulum sit amet.

Service Contact

This is the information displayed on a Service Card for users to contact.

Email Address	No email >
Phone Number	No phone number >
Address	No address >

Actions

Add Action

Provide information to users of the actions related to the service card and connect them for callbacks.

Name	Action Type	Last Updated
No action has been added		

Policy

Design

myGov | Dashboard | Platform Management | User Management | Integrations | Settings | Account

← Back to [Service Name]

Add Policy To Service Card

Policies can be applied at both the organisation and service level. User will be asked to consent to available policies during the service card onboarding. Policies can be managed within Policies under Platform Management.

Search keywords

The Policy Name

Ipsum voluptatem aliquam non. Et officiis non porro reiciendis nesciunt. Sunt sequi eligendi et. Quasi quod sed dolores nostrum minima.

Health Service Policy

Ipsum voluptatem aliquam non. Et officiis non porro reiciendis nesciunt. Sunt sequi eligendi et. Quasi quod sed dolores nostrum minima.

Long Policy Name

Et officiis non porro reiciendis nesciunt. Sunt sequi eligendi et. Quasi quod sed dolores nostrum minima.

A Policy Name

Ipsum voluptatem aliquam non. Et officiis non porro reiciendis nesciunt. Sunt sequi eligendi et. Quasi quod sed dolores nostrum minima.

Somewhat Long Policy Name

Ipsum voluptatem aliquam non. Et officiis non porro reiciendis nesciunt. Sunt sequi eligendi et. Quasi quod sed dolores nostrum minima. Ipsum voluptatem aliquam non.Quasi quod sed dolores nostrum minima.

Health Service Policy

English

Ipsum voluptatem aliquam non. Et officiis non porro reiciendis nesciunt. Sunt sequi eligendi et. Quasi quod sed dolores nostrum minima.

Et officiis non porro reiciendis nesciunt.

Consent Scopes

- Maiores officia consequatur.
- Laboriosam corrupti consectetur.
- Provident dolorem et in vero.
- Repellendus sit corrupti dolor doloremque.

Rules

- Verify identity
- Laboriosam corrupti consectetur.
- Provident dolorem et in vero.
- Repellendus sit corrupti dolor doloremque.

Adding A Policy

This same layout will be used when adding a policy to the Organization.

Scroll

Usability Testing

Session Overview

Method: Moderated A/B Testing

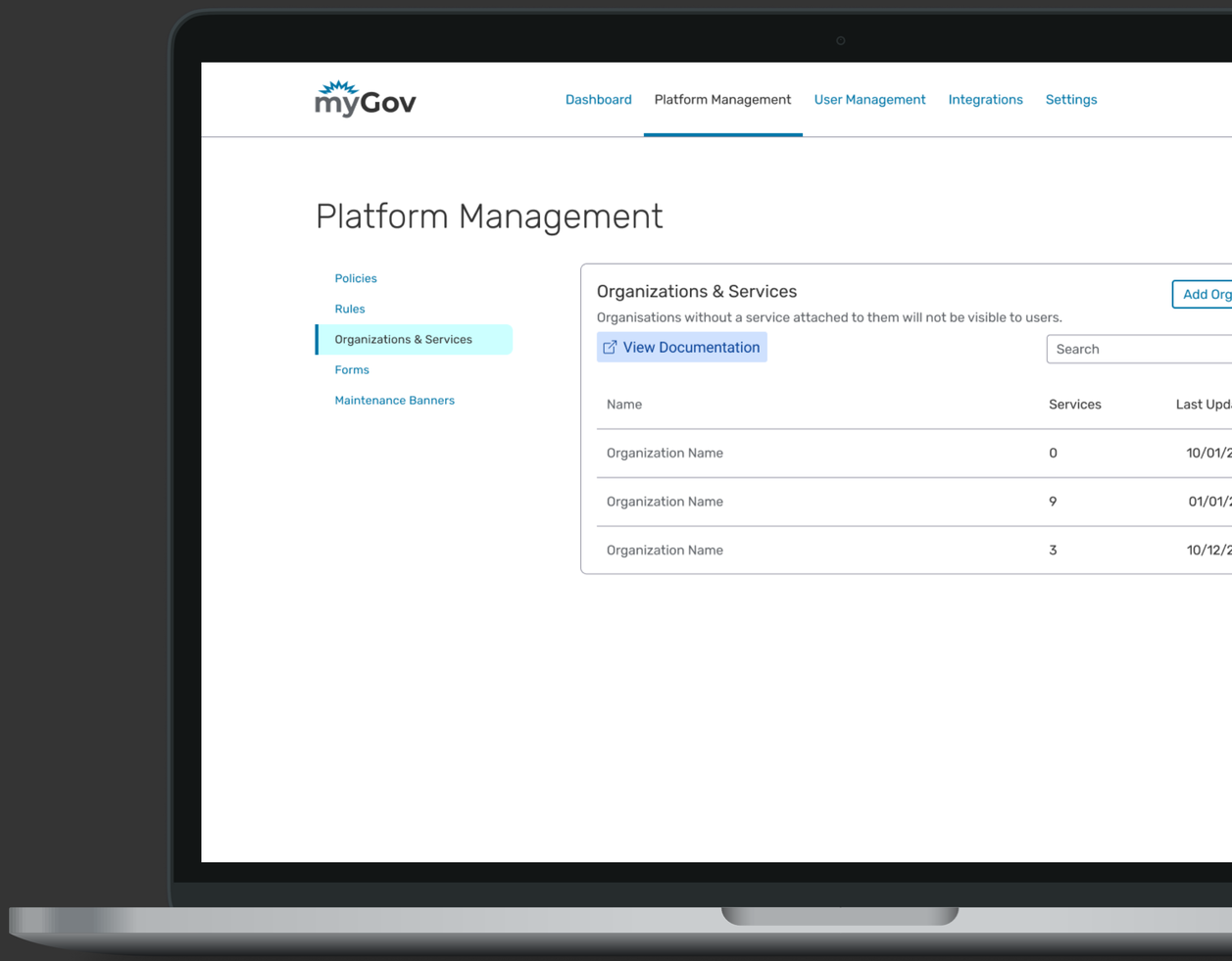
Timeline: April - May 2024

Participants: 5

Tasks:

Create and Publish a Service

Delete a Service



Discoveries

Archive over Delete

Admins weren't comfortable with the idea of deleting a service or organization and losing data. They would feel more comfortable archiving these instead.

Note: This was reoccurring feedback in the sessions, so I updated the designs for our last test session. Last participant only had positive feedback about the flows.

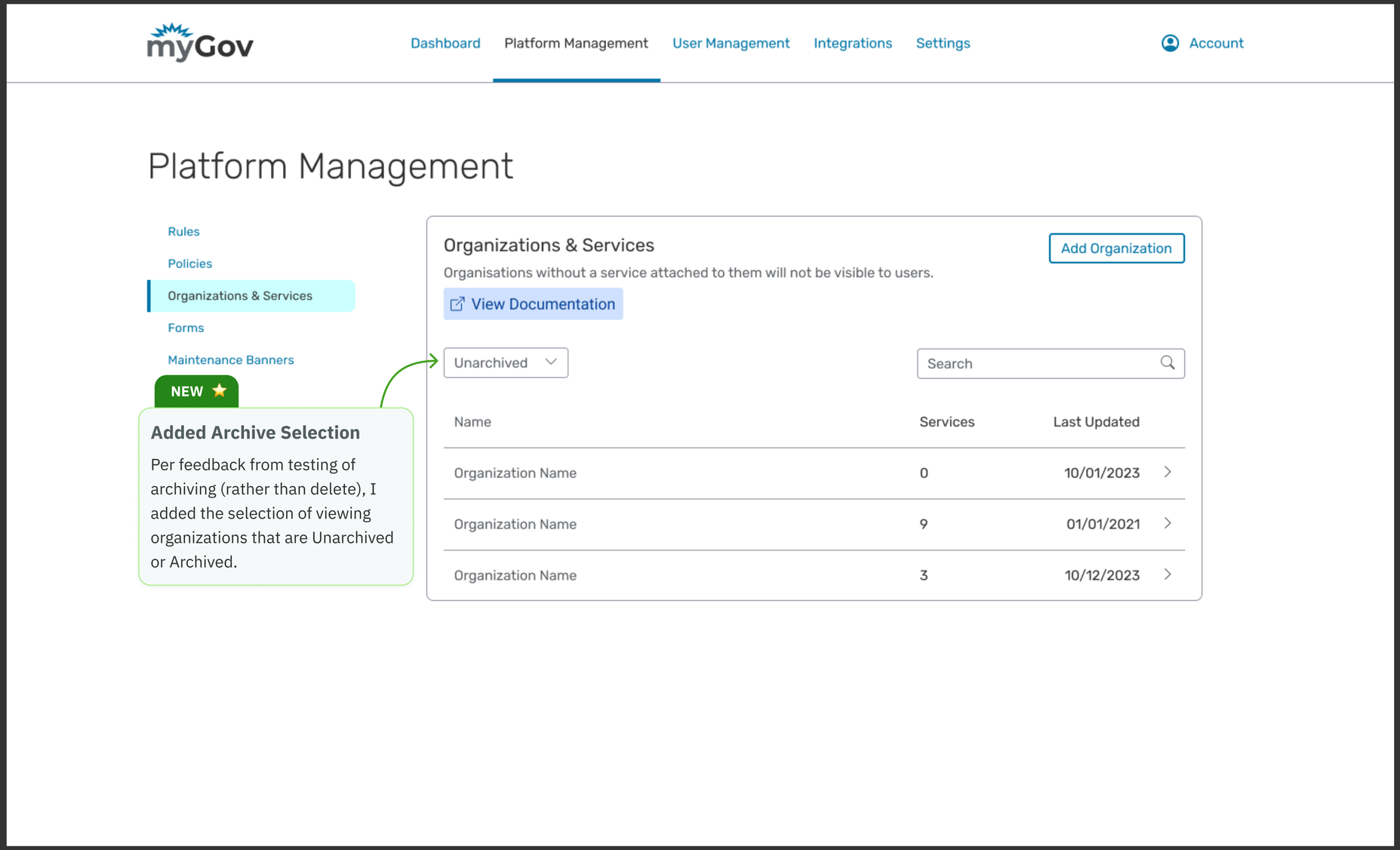
Seasonal Services

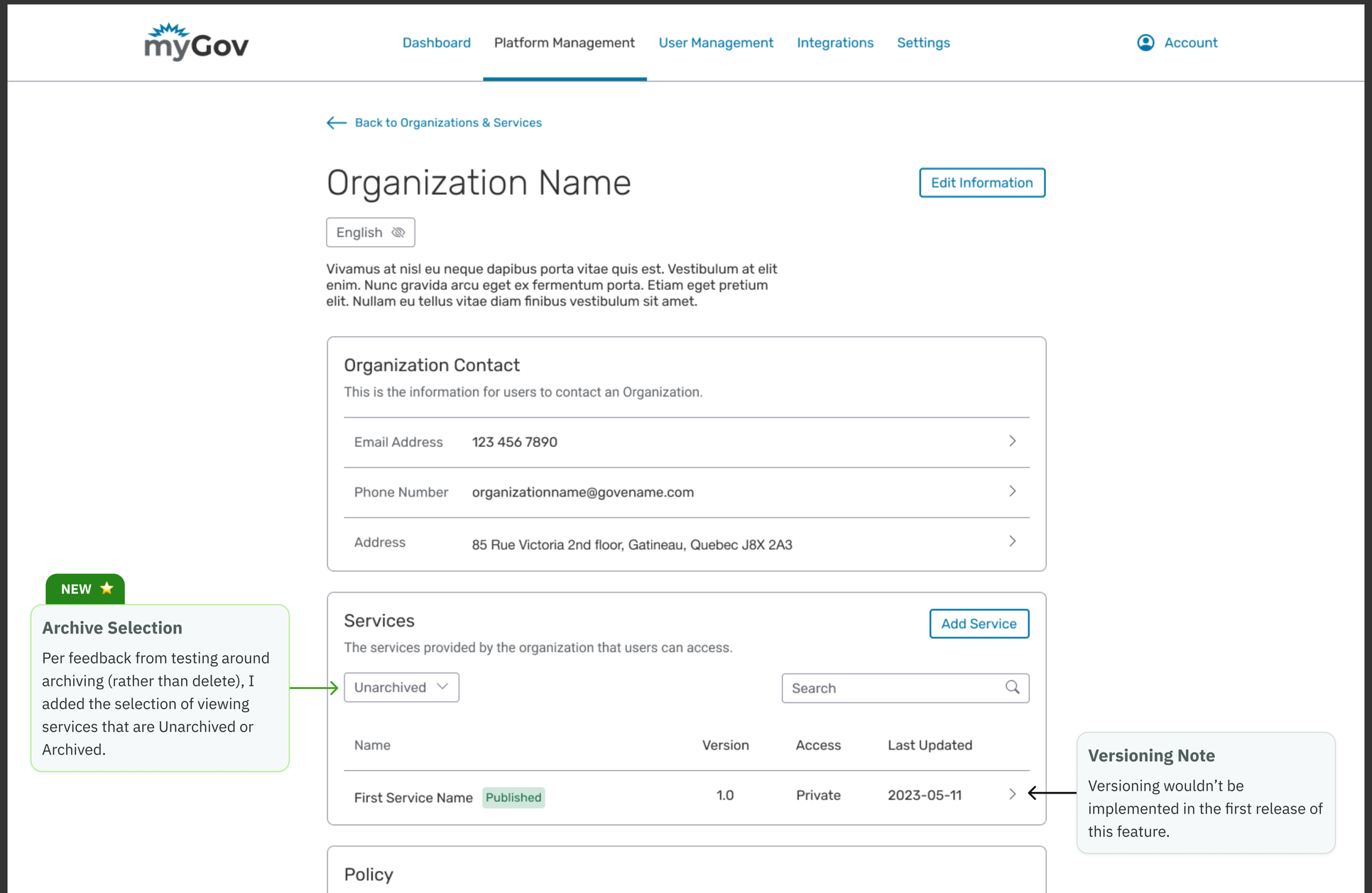
Some services (such as permits for hunting and fishing) are only made available seasonally. Allowing services to be year round or seasonal could help in maintenance efforts. This will be a future implementation.

Invite-Only Services

Some Orgs have services that are not publicly available and access is provided by email. Some may instead use the email invite for internal tests before launching the service.

Design


myGov
Dashboard
Platform Management
User Management
Integrations
Settings
Account
Platform Management
Rules
Policies
Organizations & Services
Forms
Maintenance Banners
NEW
Added Archive Selection
Per feedback from testing of archiving (rather than delete), I added the selection of viewing organizations that are Unarchived or Archived.
Organizations & Services
Add Organization
Organisations without a service attached to them will not be visible to users.
View Documentation
Unarchived
Search
Name
Services
Last Updated
Organization Name
0
10/01/2023
Organization Name
9
01/01/2021
Organization Name
3
10/12/2023



NEW ★

Archive Selection

Per feedback from testing around archiving (rather than delete), I added the selection of viewing services that are Unarchived or Archived.

Versioning Note

Versioning wouldn't be implemented in the first release of this feature.

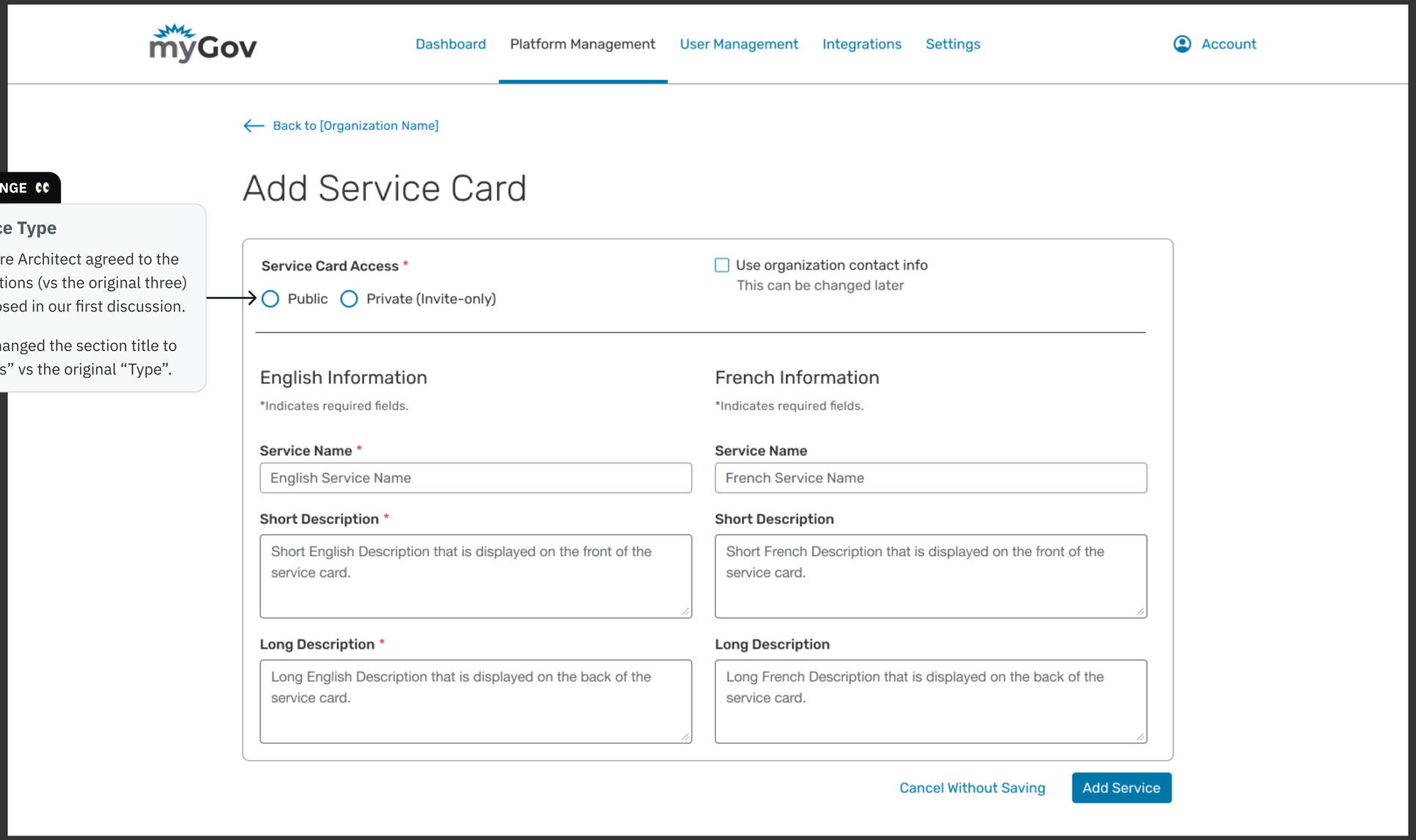
Scroll

CHANGE

Service Type

Software Architect agreed to the two options (vs the original three) I proposed in our first discussion.

Also changed the section title to “Access” vs the original “Type”.



Design

myGov | Dashboard | Platform Management | User Management | Integrations | Settings | Account

Versioning Note

Versioning wouldn't be implemented in the first release of this feature but all designs are ready for devs.

← Back to [Organization Name]

Service Name V1.1

Edit Information

English | Published | Private | Invite Users

Created: 2019-02-11 Last Updated: 2019-02-12 View Version History

Preview Service

Vivamus at nisl eu neque dapibus porta vitae quis est. Vestibulum at elit enim. Nunc gravida arcu eget ex fermentum porta. Etiam eget pretium elit. Nullam eu tellus vitae diam finibus vestibulum sit amet.

Service Contact

This is the information displayed on a Service Card for users to contact.

Email Address	123 456 7890
Phone Number	organizationname@govename.com
Address	85 Rue Victoria 2nd floor, Gatineau, Quebec J8X 2A3

Actions

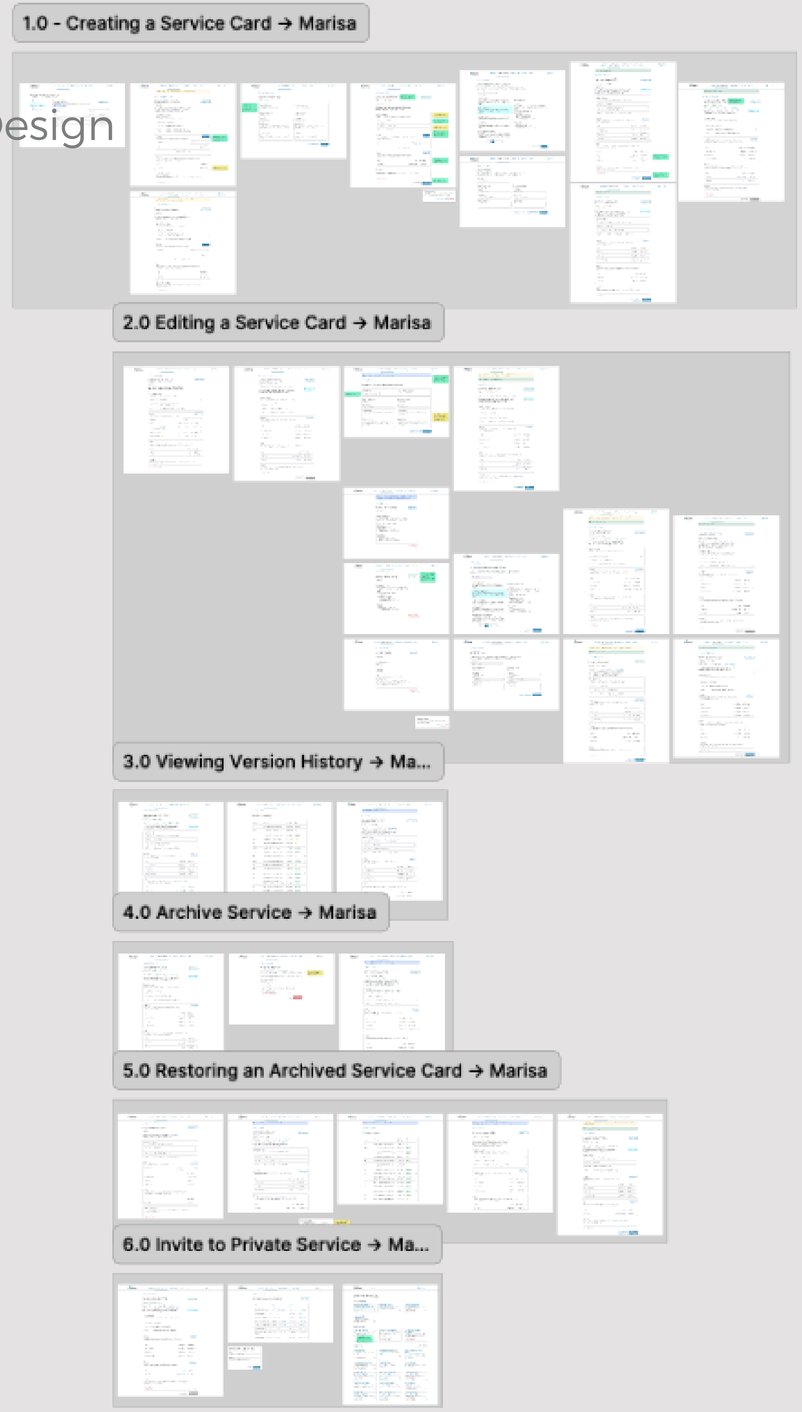
Add Action

Provide information to users of the actions related to the service card and connect them for callbacks.

Name	Action Type	Last Updated
First Action Name	Placeholder	2023-08-03
Action Name	Placeholder	2023-08-03

Scroll

Design



Handoff

The full figma file covered the following flows for the feature:

- Creating a Service
  - Add service info
  - Adding Actions
  - Adding Policy
  - Publishing the Service
- Editing a Service
  - Editing Service info
  - Editing/Removing Actions
  - Changing/Removing Policy
- Viewing Version History
- Archiving Service
- Restoring an Archived Service
- Invite to Private Service
- User Testing Summary

Outcomes

With the care to follow our platforms UI patterns and established UX principles in the redesign, as well as testing each flow, we had one client sign off on migrating to the new platform 3 months ahead of schedule – with minimal alterations requests to the interface.

Further clients expect to greatly increase the number of e-service they offer after moving to the new platform.

Until the EGDI scoring is released in 2026, we cannot say if C1 has made an impact to Canada’s standing in the ranks, but we have high hopes.

"With CitizenOne, we plan to increase the number of digital services available from 9 to 160 this year."

– Gov Client

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